# MARTA KOWAL-BRANDT

QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure)

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## PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

QA automation engineer specialising in CI/CD and test infrastructure with 7 years of experience, including ownership of CI/CD pipelines and developer tooling for three product teams (~25 developers). Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes and monthly CI runner costs by about 30%, while building Kubernetes-based ephemeral test environments with Helm and GitLab CI. Brings namespace-level Kubernetes experience on a shared cluster, plus practical infrastructure-as-code experience from a personal Terraform project and hands-on experience with Docker, Linux, and monitoring. Known for taking ownership of shared engineering workflows and documenting them for team onboarding. Targeting cloud infrastructure and DevOps roles focused on CI/CD, infrastructure automation, Kubernetes-based environments, observability, SSL/TLS certificate management, and developer tooling.

## TECHNICAL SKILLS

**Infrastructure & CI/CD:** Terraform (personal project), GitLab CI, Jenkins, Docker, Docker Compose, Helm, Argo CD
**Containers & Linux:** Kubernetes (namespace-level experience), k3s, Linux
**Monitoring & data:** Prometheus, Grafana, Loki, PostgreSQL
**Networking & TLS:** Traefik ingress, cert-manager, SSL/TLS certificate management (no mTLS experience stated)
**Languages & tools:** Python, Bash, Java (test code), SQL, Git, Ansible (basic)
**Cloud & Infrastructure:** Terraform (personal Hetzner VPS project), AWS EC2 and S3 (learning basics), Hetzner VPS, Ansible (basic)
**Testing:** pytest, Playwright, Selenium, Postman

## PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

**QA Automation Engineer (Test Infrastructure)** | Odrava Health Software, Wroclaw 2021–Present

- Own GitLab CI pipeline infrastructure and merge-request test-environment workflows for three product teams (~25 developers), covering build, unit, integration and end-to-end test stages and artifact publishing.
- Reduced average pipeline duration from 38 to 14 minutes by profiling workflows, parallelising test jobs, adding dependency caching, and separating end-to-end tests into their own stage; monthly CI runner costs fell by about 30%.
- Built short-lived merge-request environments for applications, PostgreSQL and seeded data, deploying with Helm to the shared Kubernetes cluster from GitLab CI. Environments are automatically removed after merge or 48 hours of inactivity. End-to-end tests run against each environment.
- Maintain a pytest and Playwright end-to-end suite of about 900 tests; reduced the flaky-test rate from 7% to below 1%.
- Wrote Bash and Python tooling to seed PostgreSQL test data and built a Python/GitLab API workflow that collected CI test results into PostgreSQL for Grafana dashboards.
- Authored the internal 'How CI Works' guide used for team onboarding and mentored two QA interns in 2023.
- Work with namespace-level access on the shared Kubernetes cluster; the platform team operates the cluster.

**QA Engineer** | Brightmill Software House, Wroclaw 2019–2021

- Tested web and mobile applications for client projects through manual and automated testing.
- Introduced a Java and Selenium automated regression suite for the largest client project.
- Configured Jenkins jobs to run nightly regression tests.

**Customer Support Specialist (2nd line)** | Brightmill Software House 2018–2019

- Investigated customer issues using logs and databases, and reproduced bugs for developers.

## SELECTED INFRASTRUCTURE PROJECTS

**Homelab k3s Cluster with GitOps** | Personal 2024–2025

- Provisioned a small Hetzner VPS with Terraform and used Ansible for basic configuration; deployed applications to a three-node k3s cluster with Argo CD; configured Traefik ingress and cert-manager for SSL/TLS certificates, plus Prometheus, Grafana and Loki for observability.

**Flaky Test Dashboard** | Odrava Health 2023

- Collected test results from CI into PostgreSQL and built Grafana dashboards showing flaky tests per team; the

flaky rate fell from 7% to below 1% after teams started fixing the top offenders.

## EDUCATION

BEng Computer Engineering | Silesian Lowlands University of Technology | 2018

## CERTIFICATIONS & PROFESSIONAL DEVELOPMENT

ISTQB Foundation Level | 2019
Certified Kubernetes Administrator (CKA) preparation — exam scheduled for January 2027 (not yet certified)

## LANGUAGES

Polish (native) | English (C1) | German (A2)